The first Dalai Lama lived in the 1400s. Throughout history, there have been fourteen Dalai Lamas. Tibetan Buddhists believe that when a Dalai Lama dies, he is born back into the world—or reincarnated—into another body, so he can continue to lead the Tibetan people and share his message of compassion.



Gendün Druppa, the first Dalai Lama